

God's Grace for Your Call

Please open to Romans 12. Romans 12, and we will see how far we get tonight. Hallelujah.

Boy, was my spirit lifted up in the music tonight. Faithful people remind me of Jesus.

Let us begin with the first verse once again. The word "therefore," of course, means, "Based on what I have already said, I am about to say this."

I beseech you therefore, brethren, by the mercies of God, that ye present your bodies a living sacrifice, holy, acceptable unto God, which is your reasonable service.

You new people have to get used to "bodies" in Tulsa. We do not say body. My body. I beseech you therefore, brethren, by the mercies of God, that you present your bodies a living sacrifice - living, holy, acceptable unto God, which is your reasonable service.

And be not conformed to this world: but be ye transformed by the renewing of your mind.

The offering of our body as a living sacrifice by the Holy Ghost, as we have studied, results in not being conformed to the world, but in death to the world. Transformation comes by the power of the Holy Ghost and the renewing of the mind, to prove what is good, acceptable, and the absolute perfect will of God.

Paul continues:

For I say, through the grace given unto me, to every man that is among you, not to think of himself more highly than he ought to think.

Grace is the unmerited, unearnable favor given unto me.

But to think soberly, according as God hath dealt to every man the measure of faith.
For as we have many members in one body, and all members have not the same office:
So we, being many, are one body in Christ, and every one members one of another.

Of course, that analogy is the human body. The hand does not do what the foot does. The eye does not do what the ear does. We have many members in one body, and all members do not have the same office. So we, being many, are one individual member in a vast body called the body of Christ.

Now notice the sixth verse very closely:

Having then gifts differing according to the grace that is given to us...

When we go back to the first verse, where he says, "I beseech you therefore, brethren, by the mercies of God, that you present your bodies a living sacrifice," we found out that somehow the presenting of our bodies as a living sacrifice results in not conforming to the world, but transformation by the renewing of the mind, to prove the good, acceptable, and perfect will of God.

What makes this so exciting is this: when he talks about the good, acceptable, and perfect will through transformation of the mind, he is not just talking doctrine. The rest of this chapter talks about a many-membered body called the body of Christ, of which you and I are individual members. He said that by the grace of God, we differ one from another.

So when he talks about proving, through offering your body as a living sacrifice, the perfect will of God, he is talking about the mind of God for Dave Roberson. What is His perfect will for my life? What has He called me to fulfill in a many-membered body called the body of Christ? What am I called to be: a hand, a foot, an eye, or an ear?

Whatever it is, my office and my gift differ from yours, first of all because God called me to that office, and it is by His unmerited, unearnable favor that He bestowed it upon me.

I did not earn it. I did not merit it. I did not deserve it. But I got it.

The office you walk in, you did not earn. You did not merit. You did not deserve. But my friend, you got it.

This is why Paul says, "According to the grace that was given to me." He says, "Look, I am an apostle. The reason I am an apostle is not because I appointed myself to apostleship, but because God, by His grace, called me from the womb and separated me to apostleship. It was not my doing."

So he says, "I want to talk to you according to the grace, the apostleship, that was given to me, that you ought not think of yourself more highly than you ought."

You did not earn your office. You did not deserve it. You did not merit it. God gave it to you by an act of grace. So why in the world do you think you are so hot?

So you are on TV. So your face is plastered over a billboard. So you are responsible for millions getting born again. You still have no right to think you are something.

Boy, this gets interesting.

A lot of people like to be apostles today.

"I am a mighty man of God."

"What are you?"

"I am an apostle."

"What are you?"

"I am a prophet."

Oh really? I am glad you told me, because I sure could not tell by looking at your tree, even though it is supposed to be in season. It is strange when you have to tell somebody what you are, especially after they have followed you around for a year. That is pretty pathetic.

Paul said, "I am going to speak to you according to the grace given to me, that you ought not think of yourself more highly than you ought. You need to think soberly." Here is the rule to think by: in proportion according to the fact that God has dealt to every man the measure of faith.

He is talking about a vast body in which you and you and you are individual members. In fact, he said more than that. By offering your body as a living sacrifice, you can prove the separation of God in your life to what you are called to be.

Whether it be apostle, prophet, or teacher, I tell you what, there would not be so many people jumping up and claiming, "I am an apostle," if they had lived in the first generation of the church. It was a death sentence, my friend.

You want to be an apostle? It was a death sentence. Paul said we were made the scourge of the earth, a mocking, laughingstock. He said, "We endured it all patiently." That is the mark of an apostle.

It was a death sentence then. With electronics now, the electronic church and televangelism, it can be a pretty glorious thing.

This is what Paul was talking about. "I am going to talk to you according to the grace that was given to me. You ought not think of yourself more highly. Here is the proportion you need to think by: God has dealt to every man the measure of faith."

We all have an individual call in a vast body, the body of Christ. You can find your call by offering your body as a living sacrifice. Of course, that is a whole other teaching on that. You will just have to go get it. I do not have time to teach it all over this hour.

Paul said we are part of a vast body, and we need to think soberly according to the fact that God has dealt to every man the measure of faith.

A measure is part of a whole. It is one part of a whole. Two halves make what? One whole. So two halves of a measure each make one whole.

Paul says every man has been delivered the measure of faith.

I woke up the other day and jumped out of bed, and my foot cried out in a loud voice, "I have something against the hand."

I said, "What?"

It said, "I have a complaint against the hand. How come the hand gets to meet dignitaries, and it is always in the wrong? You use it to preach with. It gets all this attention. What do I get? Thirty-second toenail inspection, shoved in a sock, stomped around, cut off from air in shoes all day, drowned in the tub. I carry the weight of this ministry. And by the way, you could lose a few. And what does the hand get? All this glory. When do people put rings on their toes? Tell me. The hand gets all this attention, and what do I get? Once in a while, an isolated ankle chain. I have somewhat against the hand."

About that time, the eye gets upset. Or the ear.

The ear says, "I have somewhat against the eye. I mean, look at me. When is the last time your boyfriend, your husband, your fiancée, peered longingly and intently into your ear?"

God just... The eyes have their whole language. They talk. I found that to be true when I was in the world.

"Would you like to go have a soda pop?"

"No."

You may say no, but your eyes will say something else.

So the ear says, "I have somewhat against the eye. They are colored different colors. Beautiful. What do I get? I get shoved under hair a lot of times. They even hang things off of me."

Which one would you rather go without? Your hand or your foot? Your eye or your ear? You would hate to have to decide, wouldn't you?

Yet it takes a different measure to run the foot than it does the hand, the eye, or the ear. God has dealt to every man the measure of faith to fill his office of grace. Both of them came from Him.

All these measures working together - your measure, your office; your measure, your office; your measure - make one whole, which is the vast body of Christ.

This solved a real problem for me. Even if I got ten million people in India born again in the next two years and met them later in heaven, and I got my old chest puffed out, saying, "Oh boy, where are they at? Where is my reward?" you know what Jesus would do?

He would say, "Look, did I not give you your office by grace?"

"Yes, sir."

"Did I not give you the faith to fill your office?"

"Yes, sir."

"Then I did not expect anything less. You had the faith to fill your office by grace. You had the faith to fill your office, not someone else's."

Aren't you glad you do not have to drag a cross across America? Thank God for anybody who would. But he got the grace for that and the faith to fill that grace.

I used to try to make preachers out of everybody. Why? Because I was consumed with it. That is all Jesus wanted to do in me: preach the Word. Day and night, messages flowed. I could not help it. Every moment, I wanted to preach.

Before I preached, I preached. You know what I mean? Anything that could not move fast enough: "Well, let me tell you something like that. What do you think about that? Hallelujah."

That is all Jesus in me wanted to do, because that is all I got the measure of faith for: to fill my office. I do not want to do anything else. I cannot pray in the Holy Ghost without that being what He brings forth. The more time I spend, the more He brings forth my office, and that measure of faith is multiplied in me to fill my office.

I do not even want to think any other way.

I used to think people were strange who did not want to do what I wanted to do. How could you not feel what I feel?

I said, "Then what turns you on?"

"When there is a penny missing off the books. I searched and searched. It took me two days to isolate it, but I found that thing."

"What happened when you found it?"

"The glory of God filled the room. I had a Pentecostal fit and prayed in tongues all night."

Thank God.

"So what do you like to do?"

"I like to sing."

"Well, I do too, but I would rather preach."

"Well, I would rather sing."

"Well, I do too, but I am not going to make a million records."

Why? Because that is all Jesus in that person wants to do.

That is where a missionary is. They will come over and show you horrible films, then chastise you because you will not go over there.

Then I love Jesus the businessman. He is the one I really love to watch work in people, because all these guys want to do is make money for the kingdom. They write \$200,000 checks and frame them, just waiting for the day they can deposit them in the ministry. All Jesus in them wants to do is make money.

"I had a business deal the other day. With a stroke of the pen, I cleared \$32,000."

You think, "Man, wouldn't you like to come and preach?"

"If you had some businessmen, I would tell them hello."

"You just do not want to?"

"No. In fact, I have a business deal I have to run off to."

They are on their way, and anointing is all over them, because all Jesus wants to do in them is make money for the kingdom. Jesus the businessman. He fills the whole body all in all.

He is all in all. But you and I know only in part, because we have only received a part. When that which is perfect comes, we will be known as we are known, and we will know Him and understand the whole thing because that which is in part will vanish away.

But until then, I only have my proportion of faith, and I only have my office. I cannot see very far beyond it. Neither can you.

But you have been delivered the measure of faith to fill your office. Yours.

When Paul said, "By the mercies of God, offer your bodies a living sacrifice," it was because you have been delivered not only the grace for your office, but also the measure of faith.

You cannot pray in tongues without activating Romans 8:27:

And he that searcheth the hearts knoweth what is the mind of the Spirit...

He that searches the hearts knows the mind and the entire plan of the Holy Ghost. When you pray, He makes intercession for you according to the will of God.

So He who is searching your heart right now is representing you from eons past, before the world ever was. He heard your life laid out on the table. Even though you do not know what it is, He does.

Every time you come here and spend a couple of hours praying in tongues, He is searching your heart. He knows the entire plan of God for your life, every minute detail. He is fervently making intercession for you according to His will, which is God's plan for your personal life in the grace and the measure of faith He separated you to in this vast body called the body of Christ.

It makes me want to put another night of prayer on. We may have to skip these Friday night teaching sessions and just put another prayer meeting in, because in Tulsa, you are pretty worded out. You are sure not prayed out though.

In fact, you want the super church.

"What do you want?"

"I go to Bible studies until noon every day."

"Then what do you do?"

"Then I work until night."

"Then what do you do?"

"Then I choose one of at least fifteen meetings going on in town and run over to one of them. And when I go to church on Sunday, I want in and I want out in forty-five minutes. Do not fool with me. I have a job. I have a school. I am holding all this down. So do not fool with me."

The one thing we are not giving time to is the Holy Ghost activating the measure of faith you have received to fulfill the grace He separated you to.

What grace? The grace you did not earn that made your office different than mine.

You want to know how to activate that measure of faith? Let the Holy Ghost germinate that seed by praying and releasing the program that is in it in tongues. For He that searches the heart knows the mind and plan of the Spirit for your life, and He can make intercession for you according to the will of God.

Boy, this could get exciting.

Let us look at this a little bit more in verse 6:

Having then gifts differing according to the grace that is given to us, whether prophecy, let us prophesy according to the proportion of faith;

Or ministry, let us wait on our ministering: or he that teacheth, on teaching;

Or he that exhorteth, on exhortation: he that giveth, let him do it with simplicity; he that ruleth, with diligence; he that sheweth mercy, with cheerfulness.

Let love be without dissimulation. Abhor that which is evil; cleave to that which is good.

Be kindly affectioned one to another with brotherly love; in honour preferring one another.

I like this part. Here is Jesus the businessman:

Not slothful in business...

Do you not like this?

Now notice again: "Or ministry, let us wait on our ministry."

The vision we get on this waiting part is, "Well, He has called me. He separated me in the eternities of time. He gave me grace to fill my office. He gave me the measure of faith to fill it with."

Boy, that makes failing hard, doesn't it?

You say, "But you do not know what came against me."

He will say, "Are you telling Me the measure of faith I gave you was not enough?"

What are you going to say? "You short-circuited me because that test and trial overcame me"? Are you saying He did not give you enough?

He has called you, given you the measure of faith, and told you to wait on ministry, on exhortation, on prophecy. Wait on it.

That waiting on it is not, "When You are ready, I am ready. Yes. What are you doing? Just waiting on God." That is the way some of us wait on Him.

"I have just been waiting on God. We are just waiting for Him to send a revival."

He will probably come and go, and you will never notice it.

Why do you think He began this chapter this way? After chapters 8, 9, 10, and 11, He gets to chapter 12 and says, "Now I beseech you therefore" - therefore meaning, "Based on what I have already told you." He has laid the instructions out in chapter 8 on how to offer your body as a living sacrifice. Now He beseeches you by the mercies of God to present it.

Waiting on God results in not conforming to the world, but transformation, to prove the perfect will of God for your life. So waiting on God is doing whatever is necessary to offer my body, resulting in transformation and proving the perfect will of God.

Waiting on God, then, is offering my body as a living sacrifice.

That is why He said it is through the Spirit that you mortify the deeds of the body. Mortify means put to death. Every time I pray in tongues and work a little more of His perfect plan into my life, then we know all things work together for good - which, by the way, is verse 28.

And we know that all things work together for good to them that love God, to them who are the called according to his purpose.

Who are all things working together for? The man who, number one, walks in the Spirit, and two, lets God germinate that seed, that measure of faith, by praying in the Holy Ghost.

Everything that comes to you that is against the perfect plan of God for your life, He can arrest it. Then we can know all things will work together for good to them that love God and are called according to His purpose.

What is His call in your life for His ultimate purpose?

He is saying it does not matter what the devil throws at you. If you are working His plan through mortification supernaturally by letting the Holy Ghost flow through you, then no matter what comes against you, God can arrest it and turn it for good.

Nothing can stop you that goes contrary to the call of God in your life if you mortify by the power of the Holy Ghost. Nothing.

It is amazing to me, when God comes on the scene, how short work He can make. You can be blubbering, bawling, wallowing around, feeling sorry for yourself one day, and owning six Cadillacs the next. I have never seen anything like God.

In prayer last night, He told us. It started flowing through me in a mystery. He told me, "I could double the blessings of My children if they would simply enter into rest."

Yes, because rest is an aggressive weapon. There is nothing like peace and rest to make you more unmanageable by the devil. If he cannot pressure you, what else does he have?

If he could kill you, he would have done it last week. If he were coming up 44, if he just wiped out Oklahoma City, we would know he was on his way. A million people died last night. Something is heading up the freeway, killing everything on both sides of the road. Some prophet stands up and says, "It is Satan. He is killing everybody. He is heading this way. Get ready to die."

They would have that kind of power if they could release it, but they cannot because they have been put under restriction. And I like that. Because if he could have killed you, he would have done it yesterday.

Since he cannot, he has to get you to kill yourself. So the only real war he has is the things he has been using against some of you:

"Well, I declare. You think I am going to have any part of this anymore? I am leaving."

The only thing he can use on you is emotions.

That is why He says:

For the weapons of our warfare are not carnal, but mighty through God to the pulling down of strong holds;
Casting down imaginations...

Strongholds are fortresses erected in our lives. He tells you what they are: imaginations, systems of thought that war and fight to replace the knowledge of God in your life. The only thing the enemy has to use against you is yourself.

Even if they get you in prison and start pulling your fingernails out, if you do not have war inside, he cannot use it against you.

So there is no temptation taking you except what is common to man. God is faithful. He will not allow you to be tempted above what you are able, but will, with the temptation, make a way for you to escape.

Again, the way of escape is not Him taking you by the nape of the neck every time you get in a mess, when tests and trials are pressing on you and people are calling you ugly and everything else. You say, "Where is the way to escape?" He reaches down, grabs you by the nape of the neck, puts you over here, and you say, "Boy, He got me out of that one."

So what does the devil do? He sends out search parties, finds you again, and says, "Ah, there they are." Then his followers come and surround you again, and you are in the same mess.

"Oh, help me, God!"

If the devil can use pressure and cares to control you, my friend, he already has next week planned for you. Pressure and care can keep you from the objective, which is mortifying the flesh and producing His plan in your life through letting the Holy Ghost edify and flow through you a couple of hours, at least four or five hours a week.

If he can keep you from that objective by a little pressure, a little personal war, then he has next month all laid out for you.

When we study the devil, we think casting demons out and doctrines and things. Folks, if you really want to see his greatest achievements, five years from now look back and see whether you did anything for the kingdom. If you did not, buddy, you have been deceived by the master himself.

There is no test taking you except what is common. He will not allow you to be tested above what you are able. Satan cannot employ more power. All he has is one inroad: imaginations, systems of thoughts, and what he can make anybody else do to you. He only has one inroad.

So when He says He will not allow you to be tested above what you are able, but will with it make a way to escape, the Greek says He will provide a landing pad.

I have found out the landing pad is not escaping the whirlwind that goes on around me. The landing pad is the condition of my heart.

What if women were my problem? What if money were my problem? What is He going to do, stick me on a desert island where there are no women? What good is that going to do the kingdom?

But if He provides me a landing pad where the peace and the grace of God develop, then Satan can throw all hell at me, and it is not going to get me off my objective.

What is your objective? Waiting on God. Mortifying the flesh. Working His plan. Activating the measure of faith. Fulfilling the operations of God. Laying up treasure against the day you walk into heaven and, for millenniums to come, have the respect of the Lamb because the flesh, the world, and the devil could not stop you.